



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Are you superstitious?



Learning Outcome

Describe complicated or unusual events in the past through a wider range of B1 language in both work and social contexts.

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about manners, customs and superstitions.
- I can talk about my attitudes toward an action.
- I can talk about hypothetical situations.

Ask your partner:

- What's your lucky number? How often do you use it?
- What superstitions do you know?





Let's Explore!

Sally blogs about the number 13. What do **Valhalla*** and the number 13 have in common?

* "Valhalla" is a place of honor, glory, or happiness, according to Norse mythology.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Halloween is fast approaching once again and to honor this amazing time of year, some of my readers suggested writing about superstitions. I am also going to try to answer my readers' e-mails about superstitions, so everyone send in your questions. Now, researching superstitions is something I love to do and one of the most popular comments is, why is the number 13 bad luck?

Now, if I were a more talented writer, I would go into more detail about this topic, but there are too many different theories as to why 13 is bad luck, so I decided to just talk about the thirteenth guest at the table.

There are two ancient events in which a 13th guest attends a dinner celebration and bad things start happening for the other twelve guests.

The first one to discuss comes from the Bible where Judas, the 13th apostle to arrive at the Last Supper, later betrays Jesus.

The second story comes from Norse mythology and involves a dinner party in Vahalla. Loki, the god of mischief, is believed to have introduced evil into the world after crashing a party attended by twelve other gods.

Now, if Judas came to my party, I would make him eat outside and if Loki knocked on my door, I wouldn't answer. Even today, guests who arrive late at my dinner party risk being turned away. Unless of course, they're cute.



Let's Practice!

What would you do if ... ?

Instructions: Match column A and Column B.

COLUMN A

1. If I were a more talented writer,
2. If I had more money,
3. If I were Judas,
4. I wouldn't crash the party
5. If I were you,

COLUMN B

- a. I would change my car.
- b. I wouldn't betray Jesus.
- c. I would read about the Norse mythology.
- d. I would go into more detail about this topic.
- e. if he invited me.



Let's Practice!

Amy gives some advice about how to solve Vanessa's problems.

Instructions: Unscramble the words in order to find the mystery sentences.

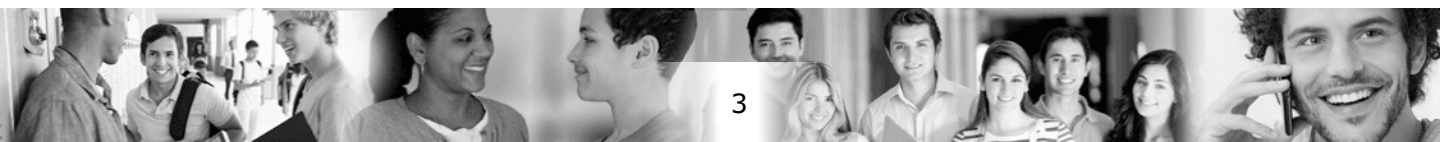
1. read / I / to / about / superstitions. / love

2. mythology. / My / Norse / suggested / mom / about / reading

3. Pam. / with / the / / decided / to / I / cinema / to / go

4. hate / drinking / coffee. / I

5. year. / to / She / hopes / next / travel





Extension Activity

What happened at the party in Valhalla?

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Write a story about what happened the night Loki came to dinner as the 13th guest.
- Make your story 8 to 10 sentences long.
- What did Loki say? What did he do? How did he bring evil into the world?
- Talk about this hypothetical situation and use gerunds and infinitives to tell your story.
- Read your classmates' stories.
- Give each other feedback on your stories.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I talk about my attitudes toward an action.

☐ ☐

I talk about hypothetical situations.

☐ ☐

I review other people's work and give feedback.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- ancient** (adjective): very old
e.g. There are two ancient events in which a 13th guest attends a dinner celebration.
- superstition** (noun): unreasonable belief in something
e.g. Researching superstitions is something I love to do.
- crashing a party** (expression): going to a party without being invited
e.g. Loki is believed to have introduced evil into the world after crashing a party.
- mischief** (noun): playful misbehavior or troublemaking
e.g. Loki, the god of mischief, introduced evil into the world.
- to betray** (verb): to be unfaithful or disloyal
e.g. Judas, the 13th apostle to arrive at the Last Supper, later betrayed Jesus.
- Norse** (adjective): pertaining to ancient Scandinavia and its culture
e.g. The mighty Thor is a character from Norse mythology.
- mythology** (noun): stories, traditions or beliefs from a particular culture
e.g. Loki is another character from Norse mythology.
- instance** (noun): a particular situation, event, or fact
e.g. The next instance of the 13th guest causing trouble comes to us from Norse mythology.
- to risk** (verb): to take a dangerous chance
e.g. Guests who arrive late at my dinner party risk being turned away.





Learning Points

Gerunds and Infinitives

A **gerund** is a verb ending with *-ing* (doing).

An **infinitive** is *to + verb* (to do).

There are rules about which verbs you can use with gerunds and which verbs you can use with infinitives. Also, the gerund can be used as the subject of the sentence.

Verbs commonly followed by a gerund:

Verbs that express **likes/dislikes**:

like

love

enjoy

hate

Example:

*I **loved writing** about superstitions.*

- *like/love/hate* can also be followed by an infinitive.

These are some verbs that are followed by an infinitive:

hope

seem

decide

start

Example:

*It took several weeks before I **decided to write** about superstitions.*

You use infinitives after adjectives.

Example:

*I was **scared to write** about superstitions last week.*

An activity can be expressed as a gerund and functions as the subject of the sentence.

Examples:

Dancing is fun.

Computing saves a lot of time.

Studying online is very convenient.

Conditional Sentences with *if* Clause

You use the first conditional with *if* clauses to exchange opinions about possible future outcomes.





Learning Points

You use the second conditional to exchange opinions about unreal or imaginary (hypothetical) situations in the future.

You use the first conditional to say it's possible that you will or will not do something. In that condition, something else may, may not, will, or will not happen.

The parts of the sentence are divided into two clauses: the *if* clause and the *condition* clause.

You use the second conditional to talk about hypothetical situations. There is no certainty that it's possible to fulfill the condition.

For example:

If I had a million dollars, I would buy a car.

Do you have a million dollars? No.

Is it possible to suddenly get a million dollars? Not really.

What would you do if you had a million dollars? Buy a car.

You use the **Simple Past verb + would**

First Conditional: 1st Clause	First Conditional: 2nd Clause	Meaning
<i>If I finish my work today,</i>	<i>I'll go to the party tonight.</i>	It's possible that I can go to the party tonight, but only if I finish my work first.
Second Conditional: If ... + Simple Past	Second Conditional: would + base verb	Result
<i>If Loki knocked on my door,</i>	<i>I would not answer it.</i>	It is an impossible situation and can only happen in a hypothetical situation.

Examples:

- If I were a more talented writer, I would go into more detail about this topic.*
- If Loki knocked on my door, I wouldn't answer.*
- If Judas came to my party, I would make him eat outside.*

